most important thing is never to give up hope on a dream."

The church bell rang the half hour. At the next clanging of the bells, she would have to go. But for now, they had thirty marvelous minutes together. She stood, walked over to him, and perched on his lap. He took her hand.

"Promise me you'll keep drawing, Rose, no matter what happens." His voice trembled slightly. She wondered if there was an unspoken fear of losing the Rose he knew. He placed his palm flat against hers, his fingers curling around hers like a lifeline.

"I promise." With her other hand, she reached up and touched the scar on his forehead. She never could have imagined on that day in Place du Martroi when she first noticed this pale, ragged spot above his eye that a year and a half later they'd end up together in a small town in the far eastern part of Germany. She wanted to believe that if they'd made it through all this and were still together, then nothing could ever come between them.

But then Reinhardt popped into her mind, unsettling her. Their conversations—she couldn't really call them that because he was the one who did all the talking—were increasingly him ranting about ancient Germanic warriors and knights and the end of time. He seemed to live in another world of his own making, which he wanted to bring her into, while all she wanted was to extract herself from him. She'd hoped that after André arrived, she could stop delivering the reports to the sick bay. She tried to tell Josef, but she knew how much he relied on the five Reichsmarks to buy extra food and medicine, especially with the women laborers arriving a few times a week from the East and hadn't yet found the right moment.

He reached into his coat pocket and pulled out a small sketchpad. "Another one for you. Always remember you're an artist," he said, handing it to her.

They kissed, and as she pulled away, she realized that the best thing she'd ever done was to bring André to Glashütte. He supported her during the long shifts at the factory, often finding clever ways to obstruct the quotas. And, with his help, she managed to forget, at least for a while, her strange evening sessions with Herr Reinhardt.